

AUGUST UPDATE

WE'RE A MONTH IN SO HERE'S THE
UPDATE OF WHAT'S BEEN GOING ON!



As a staff, we spent our first week officially getting to work and preparing for the year ahead. We spent the week learning more about this year's theme of hospitality and going over what our weeks will actually look like throughout the year. We talked through our schedules, responsibilities, ministry areas, and what it will look like to serve students well.

We also spent time together in prayer and worship, and heard from Mrs. Deb Walters, director of the Milledgeville Christian Counseling Center, about discipleship and some of the harder topics we may encounter in ministry. I got to lead a devotional and talked about having an "eye for the small," learning to notice the little moments and people who might otherwise be overlooked.



The following week was focused on preparing for our interns and student leaders to arrive. We had intern training Wednesday through Friday, along with Cat Crew on Thursday, where we helped freshmen move into their dorms and made move-in day a little easier. That Saturday, during leader training, we broke out into ministry areas and I got to lead the community meeting where I got to hear from the community leaders about ideas and plans they envision for the year.



We also spent time preparing for Coffeehouse, including learning how to make drinks and getting to create my own: The Shud (a lemonade and tea mix with a splash of blueberry syrup) in honor of a nickname a former coordinator gave me during my freshman year that somehow stuck. More on Coffeehouse to come!



After all the preparation, it was finally time for students to come back! We kicked off the first day of classes with the Yarty (Yard Party), a front campus hangout where students could meet each other, connect with leaders, and get plugged into Fresh, our freshman ministry (if that's relevant to them). We had sodas, games, and our Fresh table where students could sign up for small groups.

That Wednesday, we had our first Awakening of the year with 403 students in attendance, as Tate kicked off our three-week series on being Seen, Known, and Loved by God. The following week brought our first official Fresh, where we heard testimonies from two sophomores about how Fresh impacted their freshman year, followed by a message from Morgan about committing your four years of college to the Lord. After our second Fresh, we had the opportunity to place 186 freshmen into small groups.



We also had our first Men's House, where 34 guys came together to build friendships, grow in their faith, and learn about accountability. Ethan, our Men's Coordinator, shared about the friendship between David and Jonathan and the importance of having strong friendships.



And, of course, Coffee House is officially back! I've started taking orders and making drinks, and I've already begun convincing people that The Shud is the drink they need! It's been a busy start to the year, but I've already fallen in love with this job and getting to serve students in so many different ways. I'm so excited to see what else God has in store for this year!

On a brief note, here's our theme verse for the year.

You can see in it the ways God sees, knows, and

loves each one of us!

HOSPITALITY

SEEN, KNOWN, LOVED

You have searched me, Lord, and you know me. You know when I sit and when I rise; you perceive my thoughts from afar. You discern my going out and my lying down; you are familiar with all my ways. Before a word is on my tongue you, Lord, know it completely. You hem me in behind and before, and you lay your hand upon me. Such knowledge is too wonderful for me, too lofty for me to attain.

Psalm 139:1-6

until
next
month!

